

ing the CGI standard. Each PHP script remains enclosed between two PHP tags commanding the server to recognise the information as PHP.

As PHP is a server-side language, its scripts only run on the operating web server. They never run in the user's browser. With PHP installed in your computer, you can use both procedural programming and object oriented programming (OOP). In some recent PHP versions, not every OOP feature is mentioned. Some code libraries and large applications have been written by using just the OOP codes.

Let's see how we can declare some PHP code:

We can declare PHP code in three different forms:

```
" <?
PHP Here we insert PHP codes
?>
```

```
" <?php
PHP Here we insert PHP codes
php?>
```

```
" <script language="php">
PHP Here we insert PHP codes
</script>
```

One of the essential features of PHP is that it supports several databases and so you can write database-enabled web pages. PHP supports the following databases:

- Adabas D Ingres Oracle (OCI7 and OCI8)
- dBase InterBase Ovrimos
- Empress FrontBase PostgreSQL
- FilePro (read-only) MySQL Solid
- Hyperwave Direct MS-SQL Sybase
- IBM DB2 MySQL Velocis
- Informix ODBC Unix dbm

PHP also supports certain other services such as SNMP, LDAP, POP3, IMAP, HTTP, COM (on Windows), NNTP and many others. The language has certain useful text processing features from the